



NEW DIRECTION

Anurag Choudhary has expanded Himadri Speciality Chemical beyond its traditional carbon business into specialty chemicals and advanced materials

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OR ANURAG CHOUDHARY, the story of Himadri Speciality Chemical Ltd has always been about materials and what they can become. Over the years, as Chairman, Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer, he has taken the company beyond its traditional carbon business into a wider portfolio of specialty chemicals and advanced materials, with research at the centre of that journey.

“Himadri’s current position of strength is the result of many factors working together, most importantly our consistent focus on in-house research and development (R&D) and innovation,” says Choudhary.

That emphasis on internal research has guided many of his decisions over the years. Under his leadership, Himadri, once primarily associated with coal tar pitch, has expanded into products such as specialty carbon black, refined naphthalene, specialty oils, sulphonated naphthalene formaldehyde or SNF (a chemical widely used as a plasticiser and water reducer in construction), and advanced battery materials. Choudhary has recognised for his contribution in this year’s BT-PwC India’s Best CEOs.

In Choudhary’s view, expanding into these areas was all about building capabilities that allow the company to serve a wider range of industries while reducing dependence on any single product line. The goal, he adds, has been to strengthen margins while ensuring steady growth.

Underlying this approach is Choudhary’s belief that chemical manufacturing is, above all, about mastering processes. When materials are understood deeply enough, Choudhary believes, they begin to reveal possibilities